

1. Semantle is a game where you try to guess a secret word of the day. You guess a word and it will tell you how close that word is to the correct word of the day, repeating until you guess the correct word. A good strategy is to go from a broad concept or idea and narrow down from there. To start, guess a broad term: person, place, idea, thing, etc. From there, guess words that are more specific, based on words that are more closely related ("warmer"). If you guess a lot of words around a certain concept or idea and they are all far from the word, try pivoting to another concept based on a different meaning or synonym. This strategy should allow you to find the concept that is closest to the word of the day, where you can guess specific synonyms, things, or ideas that will lead you to the word of the day.
2. I enjoy the concept of problem solving, and am always thinking about how to improve things or make them better. I am a meteorologist by training, so I have been thinking about ways to make weather communication and forecasting more intuitive for the general public. A project I have taken on has been creating new maps for important meteorological information (Storm Prediction Center outlooks, National Weather Service watches, warnings, and advisories, etc.) and tying these to updated population statistics (from the 2020 census). I enjoyed the multi-step challenge this presented: obtaining census tract data from the census website, obtaining up to date meteorological information from various repositories and sources (GeoJSONs from the SPC website, unpacking tar and zip files from the NWS, etc.), using GIS and Python to plot these data geospatially, finding the intersecting tracts with the outlooks/data, and producing a clean, finalized output with both a map and the population affected. Solving these multi-step types of problems is something I greatly enjoy, and something that will be useful for a role like the Forward Deployed Operator with WindBorne.